

Meaningful Credentials in Inclusive Post Secondary Education

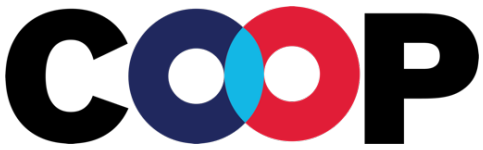
Reflections from UIC's "Co-Op Program"

Kaitlin Stober



Think College Project Director's Meeting, July 2022





COOP

Presentation Overview

1. Introduction

- a. UIC's Co-Op Program and Team

2. What is a “Meaningful” Credential?

- a. Inclusive Post Secondary Education
- b. Co-Op Program Design

3. Accreditation Process

- a. Roadmap
- b. FAQ and our Strategic Responses



Introduction

Kaitlin Stober

kstober@uic.edu

- Visiting Senior Research Specialist in our Department on Disability and Human Development (DHD), and associated Illinois state UCEDD (IDHD)
- Co-Op Program Coordinator
- MS in Disability Studies
- Sibling (and Board Member of Illinois SIBS)
- Board Member, Illinois Department of Human Services: Developmental Disabilities Division
- Sister Agency - Illinois Council on Developmental Disabilities



Dr. Kate Caldwell
Co-Principal Investigator



Dr. Tamar Heller
Co-Principal Investigator



Litany Esguerra, M.A.
Academic Advisor



Jordyn Jensen, M.Ed.
Career Coach



Kaitlin Stober, M.S.
Project Coordinator



Sarah Chew, M.Ed.
Academic Coach



Tia Nelis
Self-Advocacy Specialist



Helen Rottier, M.A.
Graduate & Teaching Assistant



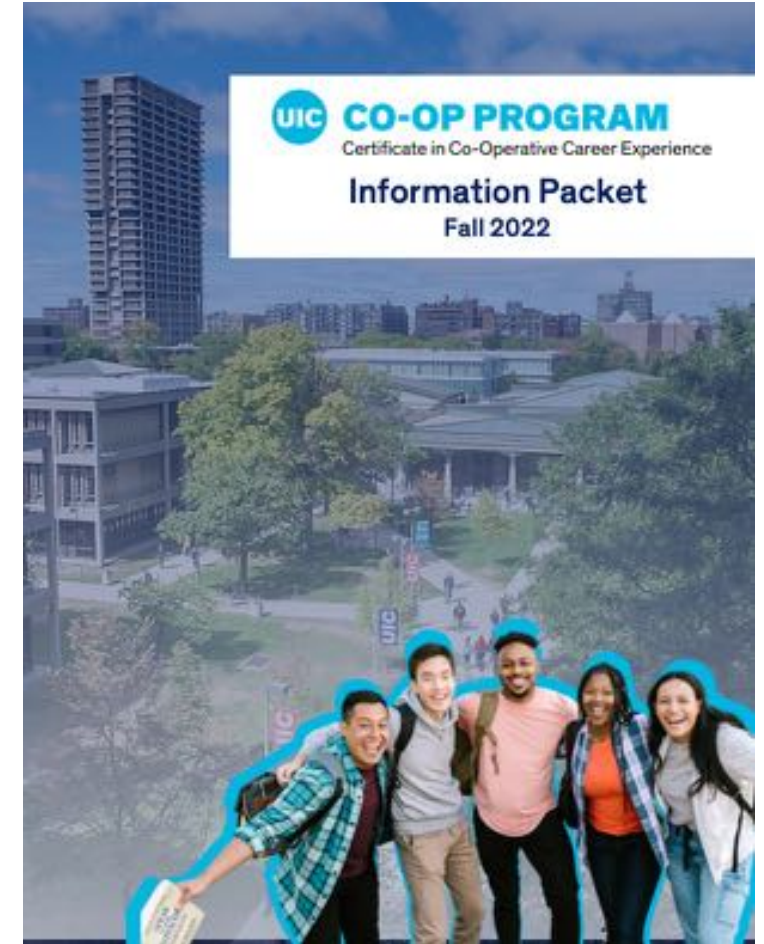
Dimitri Nesbitt, M.U.P.P.
Knowledge Translation Specialist



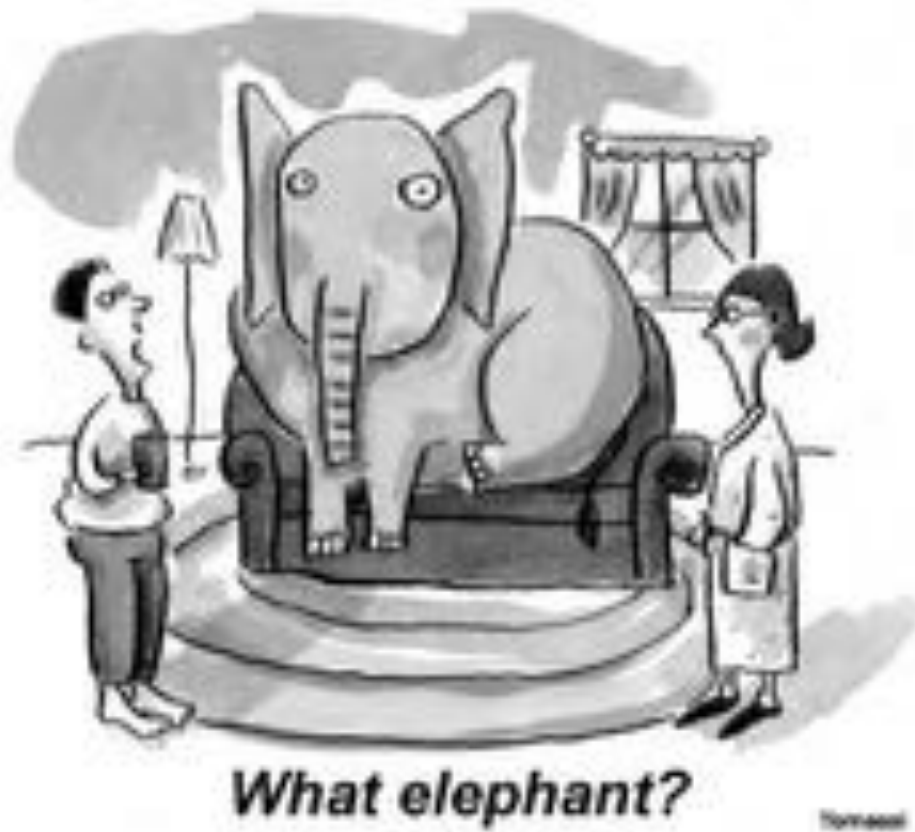
Asha Rao, M.OT
Graduate Research Assistant

Co-Op Program Overview

- 2-year, full-time program
- Official, credit-bearing UIC pre-baccalaureate certificate
- Disability Studies centered, based in our Department of Disability and Human Development
- 100% of academic classes are inclusive
- Career focus with paid community internships
- Co-Op specific supports and campus-wide supports
- Full access to UIC campus, student centers, and student activities



Co-Op is a NEW program





What makes a credential “meaningful” ?

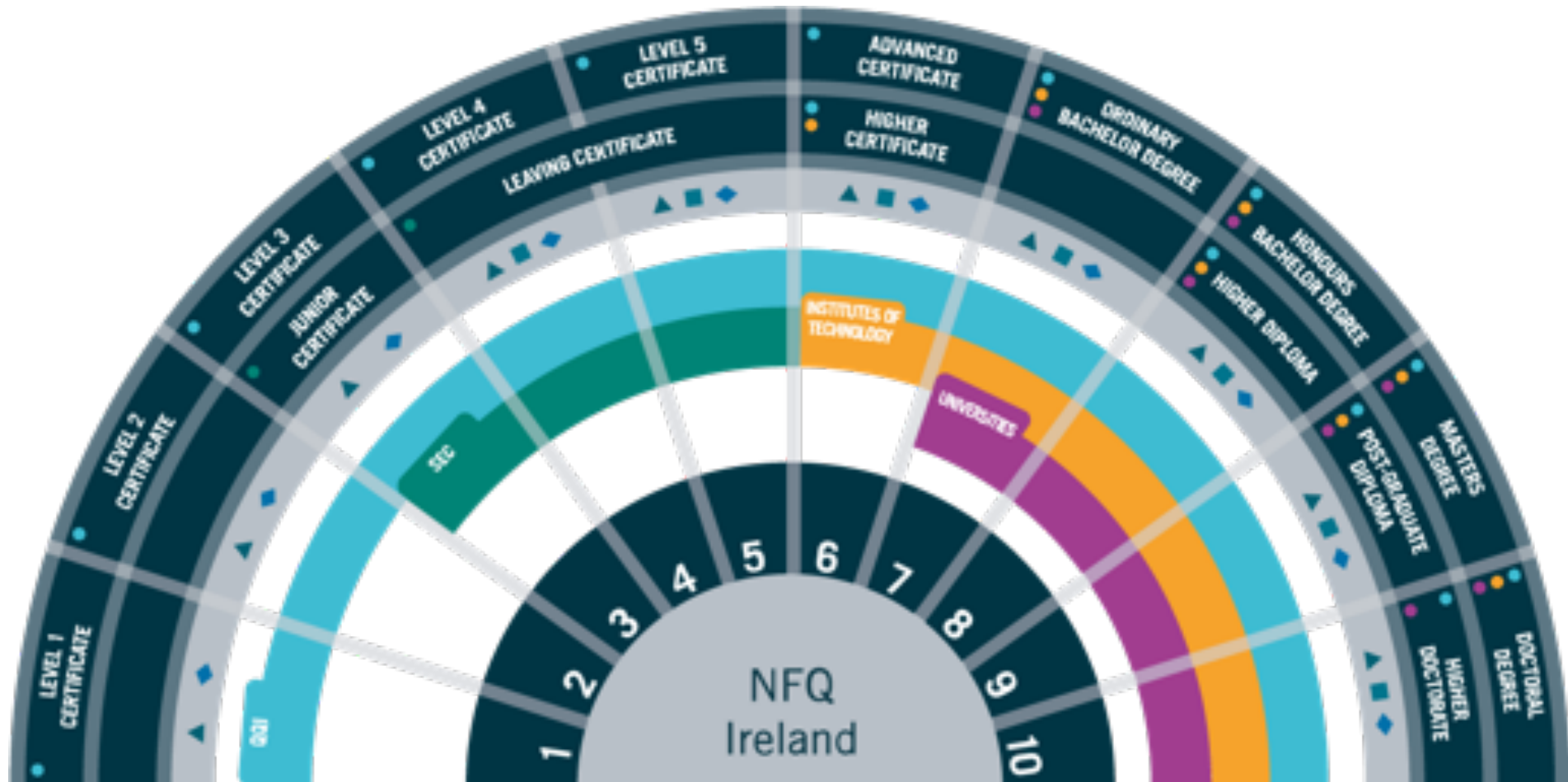
Background: Trinity College Dublin



Trinity College Dublin
Coláiste na Tríonóide, Baile Átha Cliath
The University of Dublin

Trinity Centre for People with Intellectual Disabilities
Certificate in Arts, Science and Inclusive Applied Practice

Background: Trinity College Dublin



Ireland: National Framework of Qualifications

What makes post-secondary education meaningful?



PSE Journey

- Relationship and network building
- Community citizenship
- Skill and knowledge development
- Career preparation



PSE Credential

- Increased earnings
- Job stability
- Career satisfaction

Building Meaning into the Model

We were conscientious when designing the Co-Op certificate that this was meant to be a model program.

We wanted the inclusion and of our students and the “meaningfulness” of the credential to be guaranteed by the program structure.

We did NOT want to rely on the goodwill of any individual administrators, faculty, or campus units.

Co-Op Certificate Requirements

Academic-focused credits:

- 4 required DHD courses (12 credit hours):
 - DHD 101, Radical Inclusion I, Radical Inclusion II, Disability Innovation Sandbox
- 4 elective courses (12 credit hours)
- All classes are taken through DHD

Career-focused credits:

- Career Builder course (3 credit hours)
- Co-Op Internship course (9 credit hours)

UIC DHD 103
RADICAL INCLUSION I
Foundations in Intellectual and Developmental Disability

NEW DHD COURSE

WHEN & WHERE

THURSDAYS
3:30 - 6:15 PM
3 credits (CRN: 48108)
ARC Rm. 239
840 W Harrison St, Chicago, IL 60607
(an active learning space on campus)

Academic & Residential Complex

What does it mean for inclusion to be RADICAL?

Collaborate In a fully integrated classroom, comprising of students with & without intellectual disabilities (ID) learning alongside each other.
■ Be a part of DHD's Co-Op Program, a post-secondary certificate program for students with intellectual disabilities!

Develop skills In plain language & easy read accessibility.

Discover new & relevant topics, such as:
■ financial equity, person-centered planning, participatory methods & the 100 social movement.

earn DHD elective credits | email Litany (lsgue2@uic.edu) for questions

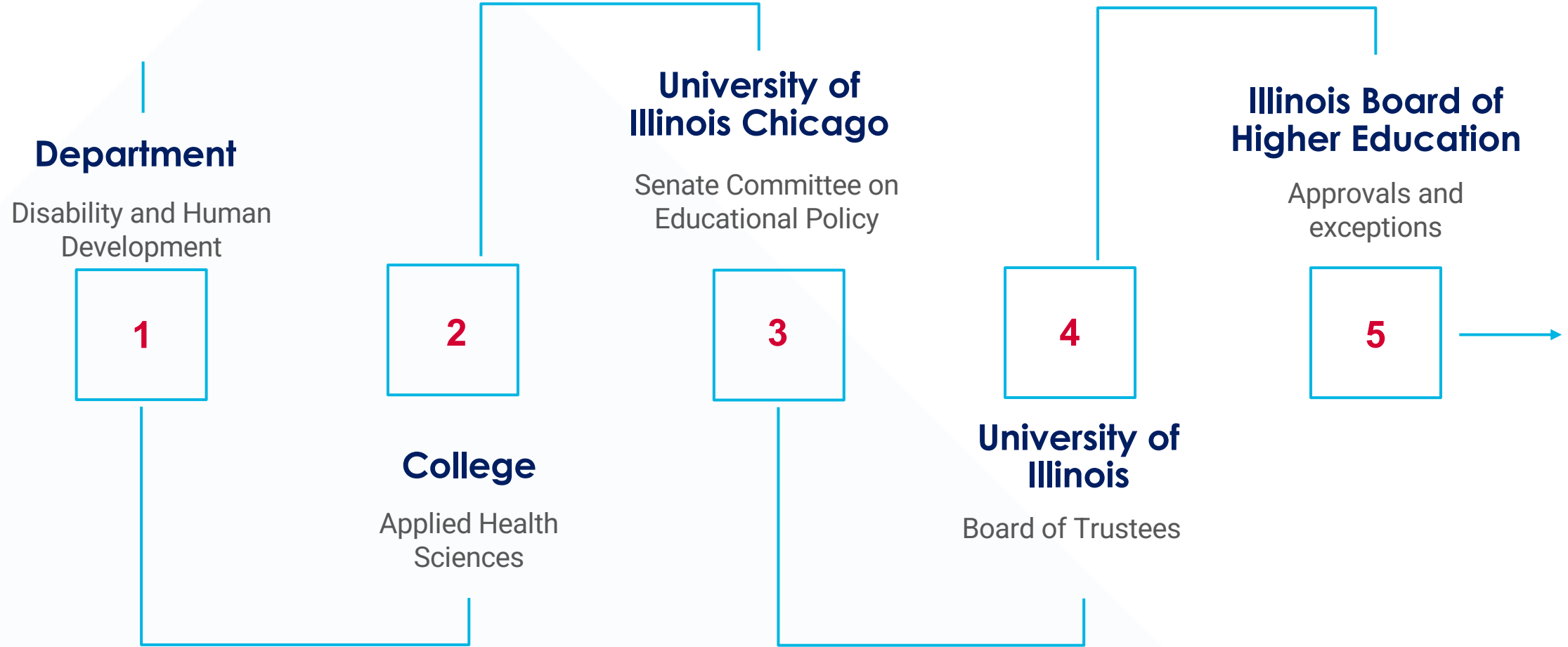
@DHDcoOp

This is designed so students can take 9 credit hours (or 3 courses) each semester.



Accreditation Process

Accreditation Process



Important Actors and Allies

University of Illinois Chicago

- Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Academic Programs
 - Director, Office of Academic Program Development
- Disability Resource Center
- Disability Cultural Center
- Financial Aid

College of Applied Health Sciences

- Associate and Assistant Dean, Academic Affairs and Administration (AHS)
- Assistant Dean, Student Affairs
- Admissions

Department of Disability and Human Development

- Department Head
- Office of Student Affairs

Proposal and Hearing Strategies



Emphasize TPSID grant obligations



Connect program goals to university/ college mission



Start small (and leave room to grow)

Challenges Raised

Academic Rigor

- *How can this program uphold the standard of academic rigor at [university]?*
- *It's not fair that students with intellectual disabilities will get the same course credits as students without.*

Low Expectations / High Expectations

- *Students with intellectual disabilities are not capable of mastering college level material.*
- *In order to be in my class, students need to be able to ... [insert high standards of critical analysis/ synthesis]*

Capacity

- *These students will take up more time/ office hours/ etc.*
- *I would need to change my entire syllabus/ course content*

Challenges WE Raised

- Peer institutions are doing this.
- Do you have coursework ABOUT intellectual disability? Then people with intellectual disabilities should have a seat in the classroom.
- Students can demonstrate mastery of course material in various ways.
- Existing accommodations can serve this population.
- Existing students have varied support needs.
- We have a dedicated team to fill in support gaps.
- Students with intellectual disabilities add value to our department and existing programs.



Questions?



Thank You!

 @CoOpDHD

 @dhdcoop

 @dhdcoop

 @dhdcoop